

Žan Grad – Curriculum Vitae

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BASIC INFORMATION

- Nationality: Slovenian
- Place and date of birth: Celje (Slovenia), October 6, 1993
- Current institution: KU Leuven, Belgium

EDUCATION

Doctoral degree in Mathematics (Ph. D.) Graduated June 27, 2025

Instituto Superior Técnico, University of Lisbon

- Member of Centre for Mathematical Analysis, Geometry, and Dynamical Systems
- Topic: *Fundamentals of Lie categories and Yang–Mills theory for multiplicative Ehresmann connections.*
- Thesis awarded with honors and distinction (*summa cum laude*).
- Advisers: Ioan Mărcuț and Pedro Resende.

Master’s degree in Mathematics (M. Sc.) Graduated September 10, 2020

University of Ljubljana, Faculty of Mathematics and Physics

- Topic: *Gauge field theory, Yang–Mills–Higgs equations and spin structures on Lorentzian manifolds.*
- Thesis awarded with the Prešeren award of University of Ljubljana.
- Adviser: Sašo Strle.

Bachelor’s degree in Physics (B. Sc.) Graduated July 7, 2017

University of Ljubljana, Faculty of Mathematics and Physics

- Topic: *Wave function collapse upon measuring the number of photons in a cavity.*
- Adviser: Tomaž Rejec.

EMPLOYMENT

Postdoctoral researcher in Pure Mathematics Sep 2025 – Ongoing

KU Leuven, Belgium

- Field of research: Poisson geometry and Lie theory.
- Adviser: Marco Zambon.

Assistant professor of mathematics Sep 2020 – Sep 2021

University of Ljubljana, Faculty of Mathematics and Physics

- Employed full time for two semesters, with an average load of 10 hours of teaching per week.
- Held exercise sessions, constructed written exams, graded students.
- Taught two master-level courses: Analysis on manifolds and Differential geometry.
- Taught five bachelor-level courses: Analysis IV for financial mathematicians, Mathematics 2 for physicists, Mathematics 4 for physicists, Basics of mathematical analysis for computer engineers, Mathematics for pharmacists.

Recorded exercise sessions for these courses are available on my personal webpage, in the [teaching section](#).

PUBLICATIONS

[1] Žan Grad, *Fundamentals of Lie categories*, J. Noncommut. Geom. **19** (2025), no. 1, 211–248, DOI 10.4171/JNCG/563. ([arXiv](#)).

[2] ———, *Covariant derivatives in the representation-valued Bott–Shulman–Stasheff and Weil complex*. ([arXiv](#)).

[3] ———, *Yang–Mills theory for multiplicative Ehresmann connections*. ([arXiv](#)).

In preparation:

[4] Žan Grad and Lennart Obster, *Obstructions to the existence of Cartan connections via Chern–Weil theory for curved differential graded Lie algebras*.

TALKS

Below is the list of talks I have given, ordered from most to least recent, including upcoming (planned) talks.

- *Yang–Mills theory for multiplicative Ehresmann connections*, Seminar of Mathematical Physics, Camille Jordan Institute (Lyon), November 6, 2026.
- *Chern–Weil theory on curved differential graded Lie algebras*, Poisson seminar, KU Leuven, October 14, 2026.
- *Yang–Mills theory for multiplicative Ehresmann connections*, Ruđer Bošković Institute (Zagreb), October 13, 2026.
- *On the obstructions to the existence of Cartan connections*, Workshop “[Lie groupoid and Lie algebroid week IV](#)”, University of Coimbra, June 24, 2026.
- *Yang–Mills theory for Lie algebroids*, Workshop “Graded geometry of gauge theories”, University of Mons, March 12, 2026.
- *On obstructions to the existence of Cartan connections*, Poisson seminar, KU Leuven, February 25, 2026.
- *Lie groupoids and algebroids*, Junior Methusalem Seminar, KU Leuven, December 11, 2025.
- *Multiplicative Ehresmann connections*, Analysis & Geometry Seminar, University of Antwerp, November 19, 2025.
- *Infinitesimal multiplicative forms*, Poisson seminar, KU Leuven, October 21, 2025.
- *Multiplicative Ehresmann connections*, Poisson seminar, KU Leuven, September 30, 2025.
- *Yang–Mills theory for multiplicative Ehresmann connections*, “[Higher Geometric Structures along the Lower Rhine XIX](#)”, University of Cologne, September 25–26 2025.
- *Yang–Mills theory for multiplicative Ehresmann connections*, University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign, [Symplectic and Poisson Geometry Seminar](#), April 28, 2025.
- *Double complexes of representation-valued forms*, Universität zu Köln, [Poisson Geometry Seminar](#), February 5, 2025.
- *Double complexes of representation-valued forms*, JMU Würzburg, [Oberseminar Deformationsquantisierung und Geometrie](#), January 31, 2025.
- *The exterior covariant derivative of multiplicative forms*, IMPA, Rio de Janeiro, November 14, 2024.
- *Crash course on Symplectic fibrations*, Radboud University Nijmegen, April 2024.
- *Mini course on Lie categories*, “[Lie groupoid and algebroid week in Coimbra II](#)”, July 2023.
- *Lie categories*, [Geometry Seminar](#) of Lisbon, Instituto Superior Técnico, Universidade de Lisboa, May 9, 2023.
- *Lie categories*, PhD seminar of Radboud University Nijmegen, April 2023.
- Two talks on *Lie categories*, [Topology Seminar](#) of Faculty of Mathematics and Physics, University of Ljubljana, March 20 and March 27, 2023.
- A series of lectures on Lie groupoids, Instituto Superior Técnico, Universidade de Lisboa, Spring semester 2021/22.
- *Mini course on Minkowski space and the theory of relativity*, Summer school of Mathematics and Physics at University of Ljubljana, August 2019.

ORGANIZING

Below are the mathematical conferences & workshops where I was a part of the organizing committee.

- [Poisson School & Conference 2026](#), August 3–14, 2026 (Antwerp & Leuven).
- [Field theory and higher geometric structures](#), Poisson Intensive Period, June 29–July 3, 2026 (Leuven)
- [Deformation problems in and around Poisson geometry](#), Poisson Intensive Period, June 1–5, 2026 (Leuven)

I have also organized several seminars:

- [Poisson seminar](#) at KU Leuven, during both the fall and spring semester in 2025/26, as well as in 2026/27.
- [CMUC Differential Geometry PhD seminar](#), University of Coimbra, June 11, 2025.
- Online seminar on the integration of Lie algebroids to Lie groupoids (by Crainic & Fernandes), spring semester of 2023/24. This seminar was co-organized by fellow PhD students from University of Coimbra and Radboud University.

CONFERENCES AND WORKSHOPS

The following list contains the conferences and workshops I attended.

- [Poisson School & Conference 2026](#), August 3-14, 2026 (Antwerp & Leuven).
- [Field theory and higher geometric structures](#), Poisson Intensive Period, June 29-July 3, 2026 (Leuven)
- [Lie groupoid and Lie algebroid week IV](#), June 22-26, 2026 (Coimbra)
- [Deformation problems in and around Poisson geometry](#), Poisson Intensive Period, June 1-5, 2026 (Leuven)
- [Gone fishing 2026](#), April 23-26, 2026 (Montreal)
- [Higher Geometric Structures along the Lower Rhine XX](#), April 16-17, 2026 (Utrecht).
- [Fifty years of BRST](#), March 23-27, 2026 (Munich)
- [Higher Geometric Structures along the Lower Rhine XIX](#), September 25-26 2025 (Cologne).
- [Interactions of Poisson Geometry, Lie Theory and Symmetry](#), June 30-July 4, 2025 (Lisbon).
- [Higher Geometric Structures along the Lower Rhine XVIII](#), January 23-24, 2025 (Nijmegen).
- [XI Workshop on Poisson Geometry and Related Topics](#), November 4-8, 2024 (Mannheim).
- [XXXII International Fall Workshop on Geometry and Physics](#), September 2-5, 2024 (Coimbra).
- [Poisson School & Conference 2024](#), July 1-12, 2024 (Naples).
- [Lie groupoid and algebroid week III](#), June 3-7, 2024 (Coimbra).
- [Higher Geometric Structures along the Lower Rhine XVII](#), May 2-3, 2024 (Bonn).
- [Lie groupoid and algebroid week II](#), July 10-14, 2023 (Coimbra).
- [The many interactions of symplectic and Poisson geometry](#), June 19-23, 2023 (Paris).
- [Lie groupoid and algebroid week I](#), September 26-30, 2022 (Coimbra).
- [Poisson School & Conference 2022](#), July 18-29, 2022 (attended online).

POSTERS

- [Yang–Mills theory for multiplicative Ehresmann connections](#) Poisson 2026 conference, August 2026.
- [The exterior covariant derivative of multiplicative forms](#) for XI Workshop on Poisson Geometry and Related Topics (Poisson in the Amazon), November 2024.

GRANTS

- [COST CaLISTA](#) European grant for short-term scientific missions. This grant enabled me to visit Ioan Mărcuț in person in Nijmegen, in the period of April and May 2024.
- PhD grant [UI/BD/152069/2021](#) by Fundação para a Ciência e a Tecnologia (FCT), Portugal.

AWARDS

- *Prešeren award of Faculty of Mathematics and Physics, University of Ljubljana*, for master's thesis *Gauge field theory, Yang–Mills–Higgs equations and spin structures on Lorentzian manifolds*, 2020.

MENTORING

- Master's student: *Youp Heida*, KU Leuven. Topic: *Contact groupoids*. Expected to graduate in 2027.
- Master's student: *Matthijs Lau*, Radboud University Nijmegen. Topic: *Fibred Lie groupoids and multiplicative connections*. Graduated in June 2025. This was a joint supervision with Ioan Mărcuț.

OTHER

I am a native speaker of Slovenian language. I am fluent in both written and spoken English (C2 proficiency).